Evaluate

Year-end close plan with Claude in 5 steps

Save this before December gets busy

Swipe for the 5 steps

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Step 1 of 5

1

Start from last year

Paste last year's close checklist and the issues log. Ask Claude to combine them into one task list, with last year's problems flagged.

Prompt to copy

From last year's material.

```
Here is last year's year-end close checklist: [PASTE]
And last year's issues log: [PASTE]

Combine them into one task list for this year.
Flag every task that had an issue last year, and add a
mitigation for it.
```

Step 2 of 5

2

Work backwards from the deadline

Give it the reporting deadline and ask for a timeline that works backwards, with buffers on the risky tasks.

Prompt to copy — From the reporting deadline.

```
Our reporting deadline is [DATE]. Working days available:
[LIST OR NUMBER].

Build a timeline that works backwards from the deadline.
Add buffers to the tasks flagged as risky. Output: task |
owner | start | end | buffer.
```

Step 3 of 5

3

Map the dependencies

Ask: "Which tasks block others?"

Prompt to copy Find the real critical path.

```
For the task list above, which tasks block other tasks?

Show the critical path and the three tasks where a one-day
delay would delay the deadline.
```

Step 4 of 5

4

Draft the owner messages

For each owner, ask for a short message: your tasks, your deadlines, who depends on you.

Prompt to copy One per owner.

```
For owner [NAME], write a short message: their tasks,
their deadlines, who depends on them and who to contact if
they are blocked. Max 120 words.
```

Step 5 of 5

5

Daily status summary

During close, paste the updated tracker each morning and ask for a summary: what's late, what's at risk, what needs a decision.

Prompt to copy Paste the tracker each morning.

```
Here is today's close tracker: [PASTE]

Summarise in five bullets: what's late, what's at risk
today, what's blocked and by whom, what needs a decision,
what finished yesterday.
```

Before you start

One rule

Task lists and timelines are fine in an approved tool. Financial results before publication may be inside information. Keep those out unless your setup is approved for it.

Free resource

Get the free prompts

Free. The link is in the post.

No signup.

